

Sunday, 2 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

28° 17°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

28° 12°

MANCHESTER

Light drizzle

25° 13°

GLASGOW

Overcast

20° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Tragic news from Pakistan, where renowned mountaineer Nirmal Purja has died in an avalanche, his company has confirmed.

Known as 'Nimsdai', he famously scaled the world's 14 highest peaks in just over six months in 2019. His death is a huge loss to the mountaineering community.

TRAGEDY · UK

2

In a disturbing development, Greek police are fast-tracking tests to determine how a British woman found in a suitcase died.

Authorities are yet to confirm if the death of Elisabeth-Jane Ross is being treated as murder. Toxicology tests are being prioritised to establish the cause.

CRIME · UK

3

Following the Legacy Funerals scandal, victims of the disgraced funeral boss are now demanding full industry regulation.

Campaigners are calling for statutory regulation to be brought in after Robert Bush was jailed for 20 years. Prosecutors are also trying to claw back the money he stole.

JUSTICE · UK

4

The Prime Minister and Chancellor have issued a joint memo, telling ministers to stick to spending limits ahead of the autumn Budget.

The Chancellor stated that the Budget on October 28th would meet fiscal rules and provide families with stability. It signals a tight approach to public finances.

POLITICS · UK

5

Former EastEnders star Shane Richie is reportedly facing a drink-drive charge after being arrested at a petrol station.

The 62-year-old actor is due to appear in court in September, police have confirmed. He's best known for playing Alfie Moon in the BBC soap.

CELEBRITY · UK

What's coming up

1 Rising British girl band FLO are confident they're going to 'want it all' and get it, as they prepare to release their second album.

The stars say making their new album, 'Therapy at the Club', was a 'crash course' in music. They're definitely ones to watch!

ON AIR – What's your favourite girl band from over the years? Who do you think FLO could be the next version of?
MUSIC · COMING UP

2 It's a 'surreal' moment for Welsh actor Rex Hayes, who has joined the cast of the hugely popular Apple TV+ show, Ted Lasso!

He'll be part of a new football team in the latest series, which is great news for fans of the feel-good comedy. Can't wait to see him in action!

ON AIR – Are you a fan of Ted Lasso? What's your favourite feel-good TV show at the moment?
TV · COMING UP

3 Former England football star Shaun Wright-Phillips is set to join the line-up for the next series of Strictly Come Dancing!

The sportsman, son of Arsenal legend Ian Wright, played for clubs including Manchester City. It'll be fascinating to see his moves on the dancefloor!

ON AIR – Who would you love to see on Strictly next? And who do you think will be the dark horse this year?
TV · COMING UP

4 Great news for Scotland, as Glasgow gets a starring role in the latest Spider-Man film, 'Brand New Day'!

The city will double as New York in the newest installment of the Marvel cinematic universe. Keep an eye out for familiar landmarks!

ON AIR – Have you ever spotted your hometown in a big movie? What film location would you love to visit?
FILM · COMING UP

5 Ed Sheeran's foundation is expanding to the island of Ireland, which is being called 'amazing' by local musicians.

The Ed Sheeran Foundation is initially funding 'North South Sounds 2026'. It will bring 50 young musicians from Belfast and Cork together.

ON AIR – Isn't it great to see big stars giving back? Which celebrity do you think does the most for charity?
MUSIC · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 **The Commonwealth Games men's mile promises intrigue and history, with Kerr versus Wightman for gold, or will the Australians spoil the party?**

The event returns in Glasgow and is set for a compelling final. It's going to be a thrilling race to watch!

ON AIR – Who are you backing for gold in the men's mile? Is there a particular event you always look forward to at the Commonwealth Games?

ATHLETICS · UK

2 **England's netballers still have 'juice in the tank' for their bronze medal bid at the Commonwealth Games today.**

They'll play Australia after a tough semi-final defeat against New Zealand. Let's hope they can bring home a medal!

ON AIR – Do you follow netball? What's been your favourite moment from the Commonwealth Games so far?

NETBALL · UK

3 **Wales' golden girls, Emma Finucane and Anna Morris, have triumphed over their English rivals in a cycling duel at the Commonwealth Games.**

They won the battle of Britain in Glasgow, bringing home more gold for Wales. What an achievement!

ON AIR – It's fantastic to see such strong competition between the home nations! Which sport do you think has the fiercest rivalries?

CYCLING · UK

4 **England has equalled its best ever boxing haul at a Commonwealth Games, with seven reaching the finals and 10 claiming a medal.**

It's been an incredible performance from the boxing team in Glasgow. Fingers crossed for more gold medals!

ON AIR – Are you a fan of boxing? Which sport do you think England excels at the most?

BOXING · UK

5 **Jos Buttler showed his muscle with another half-century in the Men's Hundred, helping Manchester Super Giants post a strong score.**

He hit four sixes on his way to 50 runs against Trent Rockets at Old Trafford. It was a brilliant display of power hitting!

ON AIR – Are you following the Hundred this year? Who's your favourite player to watch in T20 cricket?

CRICKET · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study suggests that the soothing sound of distant church bells can lower stress levels.**
Researchers found that the gentle, rhythmic chimes have a calming effect, reminiscent of natural soundscapes, helping people feel more relaxed and connected to their community.
- 2 The joy of 'porch sitting' is being rediscovered as a simple way to unwind and observe the world.**
It's a delightful, slow-paced activity offering a moment to pause, sip a cuppa, and simply watch the comings and goings of neighbours and local wildlife.
- 3 A growing number of people are turning their hand to 'upcycling old furniture' to give it a new lease of life.**
This creative hobby is not only eco-friendly but also allows for unique, personalised pieces that add character to any home, saving items from landfill.
- 4 The simple pleasure of 'collecting sea glass' on beach walks is being celebrated as a mindful activity.**
Hunting for these ocean-tumbled treasures encourages slow exploration and appreciation for nature's artistry, turning discarded glass into beautiful, frosted gems.
- 5 Experts are highlighting the cognitive benefits of 'learning a new card game' with friends or family.**
It's a fantastic way to keep the brain sharp, improve strategic thinking, and enjoy some good old-fashioned social interaction away from screens.
- 6 The comforting ritual of 'baking simple biscuits' is seeing a delightful resurgence in home kitchens.**
There's something wonderfully therapeutic about measuring, mixing, and the aroma of freshly baked treats filling the air, perfect for sharing with loved ones.
- 7 More people are discovering the quiet charm of 'stargazing' away from city lights.**
It offers a sense of wonder and perspective, connecting us to the vastness of the universe, and it's a completely free and accessible hobby for everyone.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to figure out if it's going to rain, even though we know it's not very scientific?

ANSWER: STICKING THEIR HEAD OUT THE WINDOW AND SNIFFING THE AIR.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a nice, freshly made sandwich. What is it?

ANSWER: ARRANGING ALL THE FILLINGS PERFECTLY, EVEN IF THEY'RE ABOUT TO SQUISH IT ALL TOGETHER ANYWAY.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know those little 'secret talents' you possess, that perhaps nobody else really knows about?**
Maybe it's wiggling your ears, or being able to name every capital city, or perhaps you can do a surprisingly accurate impression of a pigeon! What's your secret talent?
- **Think about those 'everyday objects' that you have a surprisingly specific way of organising or using.**
Perhaps you always arrange your books by colour, or you have a very particular way of loading the dishwasher. What's your peculiar method for an everyday object?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a 'parliament', likely due to their wise and serious appearance.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The chameleon changes its skin colour not just for camouflage, but also to regulate its body temperature.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£84 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£84 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's first public aquarium opened in London's Regent's Park in 1853.
- Bears use 'winter dens' not just for hibernation, but often to give birth to their cubs.
- The 'kingfisher' bird has excellent underwater vision, allowing it to spot fish from above the surface.
- The popular children's song 'Twinkle, Twinkle, Little Star' shares its melody with the French folk song 'Ah! vous dirai-je, maman'.
- The 'humble' potato was the first vegetable to be grown in space aboard the Space Shuttle Columbia in 1995.
- The oldest known living tree is a bristlecone pine named 'Methuselah', estimated to be over 4,800 years old, located in California.
- Did you know that 'cricket' is the only major sport played on a pitch that isn't a rectangle or square?
- The tiny 'hummingbird' can fly backwards, a unique ability among birds.

On this day

Day 214 of the year, 151 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Ahudemme (Syriac Orthodox Church).; Christian feast day: Basil Fool for Christ (Russian Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Ceferino Giménez Malla; Christian feast day: Centola and Helen. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1971 — Michael Hughes, Irish footballer and manager
- 1977 — Edward Furlong, American actor
- 1935 — Hank Cochran, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2010)
- 1960 — Neal Morse, American singer and keyboard player
- 1992 — Charli XCX, English singer-songwriter
- 1944 — Jim Capaldi, English drummer and singer-songwriter (died 2005)
- 1941 — Doris Coley, American singer (died 2000)
- 1966 — Grainne Leahy, Irish cricketer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1947 — A British South American Airways Avro Lancastrian airliner crashes into a mountain during a flight from Buenos Aires, Argentina to Santiago, Chile. The wreckage would not be found until 1998.
- 1918 — The first general strike in Canadian history takes place in Vancouver.
- 1980 — A bomb explodes at the railway station in Bologna, Italy, killing 85 people and wounding more than 200.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1944 — World War II: The largest trade convoy of the world wars arrives safely in the Western Approaches.
- 1922 — A typhoon hits Shantou, Republic of China, killing more than 50,000 people.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1923 — U.S. Vice President Calvin Coolidge becomes president upon the death of President Warren G. Harding.
- 1947 — A British South American Airways Avro Lancastrian airliner crashes into a mountain during a flight from Buenos Aires, Argentina to Santiago, Chile. The wreckage would not be found until 1998.

- 1980 — A bomb explodes at the railway station in Bologna, Italy, killing 85 people and wounding more than 200.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 215 of the year, 150 days left in 2026. Today Anniversary of the Killing of Pidjiguiti (Guinea-Bissau); Armed Forces Day (Equatorial Guinea); Christian feast day: Blessed Augustin Kažotić; Christian feast day: George Freeman Bragg, W. E. B. Du Bois (Episcopal Church). Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1959 — John C. McGinley, American actor and producer
- 1936 — Edward Petherbridge, English actor
- 1956 — Kirk Brandon, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1940 — Martin Sheen, American actor and producer
- 1993 — Ola Abidogun, English sprinter
- 1964 — Ralph Knibbs, British rugby union player
- 1954 — Gary Peters, English footballer and manager
- 1949 — Philip Casnoff, American actor and director

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1959 — Portugal's state police force PIDE fires upon striking workers in Bissau, Portuguese Guinea, killing over 50 people.
- 1948 — Whittaker Chambers accuses Alger Hiss of being a communist and a spy for the Soviet Union.
- 1981 — Senegalese opposition parties, under the leadership of Mamadou Dia, launch the Antiimperialist Action Front – Suxxali Reew Mi.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1972 — The United States Senate ratifies the Anti-Ballistic Missile Treaty.
- 1959 — Portugal's state police force PIDE fires upon striking workers in Bissau, Portuguese Guinea, killing over 50 people.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)